



Name: _____ Cohort/Batch: _____ Date: _____ Score: _____

NODE.JS PRACTICE SHEET - 10 CONCEPTUAL Q&A

10 Q&A on event loop, streams, clustering, and async patterns

TOTAL: 10 QUESTIONS

Q1 What are the phases of the Node.js event loop?

Threat Model

Q6 How do you handle errors in async Node.js code?

Observability

Q2 What is the difference between `process.nextTick()`, `setImmediate()`, and `setTimeout(fn,0)`?

Architecture

Q7 What is the Node.js Buffer class and when is it needed?

Lifecycle

Q3 How does Node.js clustering work?

Configuration

Q8 When should you use Node.js `worker_threads` vs cluster?

Compliance

Q4 What is backpressure in Node.js streams and why does it matter?

Hardening

Q9 What operations use the libuv threadpool in Node.js?

Testing

Q5 What is the difference between CommonJS `require()` and ES module `import`?

SSO / IdP

Q10 How do you profile a Node.js application for performance?

Tuning



ANSWER KEY & EXPLANATORY SOLUTIONS

Comprehensive verified answers, best-practice configs, security controls & reference

VERIFIED SOLUTIONS

A1 Timers (setTimeout/setInterval callbacks),

Mitigation

Timers (setTimeout/setInterval callbacks), Pending callbacks (I/O errors), Idle/Prepare (internal), Poll (I/O events, blocking if nothing else pending), Check (setImmediate callbacks), Close callbacks. Each phase has a queue that drains before moving to the next.

A6 Callback style: check the first err

Observability

Callback style: check the first err argument. Promises: .catch() or try/catch in async functions. Unhandled rejections can crash the process in newer Node versions. Use process.on('uncaughtException') and 'unhandledRejection' as last-resort safety nets.

A2 process.nextTick() runs before any I/O callbacks,

Primitives

process.nextTick() runs before any I/O callbacks, at the end of the current operation highest priority. setImmediate() runs in the Check phase after I/O callbacks. setTimeout(fn,0) runs in the Timers phase, which may be after I/O depending on timing.

A7 Buffer represents fixed-size binary data outside

Automation

Buffer represents fixed-size binary data outside the V8 heap (no GC pressure). It is used when working with raw TCP streams, file system data, or binary protocols where encoding is not UTF-8. Buffer.from(data, 'base64') and buf.toString('hex') convert formats.

A3 cluster.fork() creates child worker processes that

Hardening

cluster.fork() creates child worker processes that all share one TCP server port. The master distributes incoming connections (round-robin on most OS). Each worker has its own V8 instance and event loop. cluster.isMaster / cluster.isWorker distinguish roles.

A8 cluster forks separate processes sharing a

Governance

cluster forks separate processes sharing a port - ideal for scaling I/O-bound HTTP servers across CPUs. worker_threads run in the same process with shared ArrayBuffer memory - ideal for CPU-intensive tasks (image processing, cryptography) without IPC serialization overhead.

A4 Backpressure occurs when a Writable stream

Gotchas

Backpressure occurs when a Writable stream cannot consume data as fast as a Readable produces it. If ignored, memory grows unboundedly. pipe() handles backpressure automatically by pausing the Readable when the Writable's internal buffer is full.

A9 File system operations (fs.*), DNS lookups

Assessment

File system operations (fs.*), DNS lookups (dns.lookup), and crypto operations (bcrypt, randomBytes in older versions) use the 4-thread libuv pool by default. Increase with UV_THREADPOOL_SIZE=8 if many blocking ops run concurrently.

A5 CommonJS uses require() (synchronous,

Federation

CommonJS uses require() (synchronous, dynamic, returns a copy). ES modules use import/export (static, asynchronous, live bindings). Node.js supports both: .cjs for CommonJS, .mjs or 'type': 'module' in package.json for ESM. They cannot be mixed without interop care.

A10 Use node --prof app.js to generate

Optimization

Use node --prof app.js to generate a V8 isolate log, then node --prof-process to summarize hot functions. Chrome DevTools (node --inspect) provides a CPU flame graph. clinic.js doctor and flame give guided profiling for production diagnostics.